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Human Values in Bauddha and Jain Darshan

BOE100

One-day revision notes: definitions, solved examples, code and important questions

Program: B.Tech | **Branches:** ALL | **Semester:** 8 | **Credits:** 3 | **L-T-P:** 3-0-0

Scheme: AKTU B.Tech 4th year, Open Elective-IV, 2025-26 onwards

UNIT 1 Introduction to Bauddha and Jain Darshan

UNIT 2 Core Teachings of Buddhism

UNIT 3 Purpose of Life, Roots of Suffering and Meditation in Buddhism

UNIT 4 Core Teachings of Jainism

UNIT 5 Liberation, Vows, Ten-fold Dharma and Modern Relevance

Original revision notes written for the AKTU syllabus, covering the human values taught in Buddhist (Bauddha) and Jain philosophy. Every unit has the same parts:

1. **2-mark definitions**: short answers you can write word for word in Section A, with the Pali or Sanskrit term in brackets.
2. **Core concepts**: the teachings explained step by step, with tables and lists.
3. **Examples and comparisons**: everyday situations that show the ideas.
4. **Key points to remember**.
5. **Important questions**: the long questions to prepare, with what your answer must contain.

How to use these notes the day before the paper

- **Morning (3 hours):** Unit 1 (why study these darshans, the shramana background, lives of the Buddha and Mahavira, common principles) and Unit 2 (three marks of existence, Four Noble Truths, Eightfold Path, dependent origination, key terms).
- **Afternoon (3 hours):** Unit 3 (freedom from suffering, nirvana, three roots of suffering, shamatha and vipassana meditation, equanimity) and Unit 4 (nine tattvas, six dravyas, three jewels, anekantavada and syadvada, Jain theory of karma).
- **Evening (2 hours):** Unit 5 (moksha, five great vows and lay vows, ten-fold dharma, comparison of Buddhism and Jainism, modern relevance), then the "Last-hour checklist".
- **In the exam:** lists carry marks here. Write the list with its original term and a one-line meaning for each item (for example all eight parts of the path, all nine tattvas). Add a modern example (stress, consumerism, conflict) to show you understand the value, not only the names.

AKTU paper pattern (theory, 70 marks, 3 hours): Section A has 7 short questions of 2 marks, all compulsory (14). Section B has 5 questions of 7 marks, attempt any 3 (21). Section C has 5 questions

(one per unit), each with two parts, attempt one part of each, 7 marks each (35). Every unit gets its own Section C question, so do not skip any unit.

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UNIT 1 Introduction to Bauddha and Jain Darshan

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Darshan (darshana):** literally "seeing"; a school of Indian philosophy that gives a view of reality, the self and the way to liberation.
- **Shramana tradition:** the ancient Indian tradition of wandering ascetics who sought liberation through their own effort, outside Vedic ritual; Buddhism and Jainism belong to it.
- **Astika and nastika:** astika schools accept the authority of the Vedas; nastika schools (Buddhism, Jainism, Charvaka) do not.
- **Buddha:** "the awakened one"; title of Siddhartha Gautama after his enlightenment.
- **Jina:** "the conqueror" (of inner passions); Jainism takes its name from the followers of the Jinas.
- **Tirthankara:** "ford-maker"; a fully liberated teacher who shows the way across the ocean of rebirth. Jainism has 24, from Rishabhanatha (1st) to Mahavira (24th).
- **Triratna in Buddhism (three jewels):** the Buddha (teacher), the Dhamma (teaching) and the Sangha (community).
- **Karma:** the principle that intentional actions produce results for the doer, in this life or later.
- **Samsara:** the cycle of birth, death and rebirth driven by karma.
- **Human values:** lasting qualities such as non-violence, truth, compassion and self-restraint that lead to the well-being of the individual and society.

💡 Core concepts

Need for studying these darshans:

- Gives a rational, experience-based approach to ethics. Both traditions ask you to test teachings yourself rather than accept them blindly; see the Buddha's advice in the Kalama Sutta.
- Offers tools for mental well-being (mindfulness, meditation, equanimity) in a stressful life.
- Teaches non-violence and tolerance of other views, which are needed in a diverse society.
- Questions greed and consumerism (aparigraha, contentment), which is relevant to sustainability.
- Part of India's heritage; influenced Ashoka, Gandhi and Ambedkar, and spread across Asia.
- Builds professional ethics (right livelihood, truthfulness, non-stealing).

Origins (historical background):

- **When and where:** the 6th–5th century BCE in the Gangetic plain (Magadha, Kosala, Vaishali).
- **Setting:** cities and trade were growing, and many thinkers were questioning elaborate Vedic sacrifices, animal sacrifice, the dominance of priests and rigid caste.
- Many shramana groups appeared; the two that lasted are Buddhism and Jainism.

Life of the Buddha

Event	Detail
Birth	Siddhartha Gautama, Shakya clan, Lumbini (now in Nepal), traditionally c. 563 BCE (many scholars now place him about a century later)
Great renunciation	Left the palace at 29 after seeing an old man, a sick man, a corpse and an ascetic
Austerities	Six years of severe asceticism, then rejected extremes and chose the Middle Way
Enlightenment	Under the Bodhi tree at Bodh Gaya, at 35
First sermon	Deer Park, Sarnath ("turning the wheel of Dhamma", Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta)
Mahaparinirvana	Kushinagar, at 80

Life of Mahavira

Event	Detail
Birth	Vardhamana, Kundagrama near Vaishali (Bihar), traditionally 599 BCE
Renunciation	Left home at 30
Austerity	12 years of intense penance and silence
Kevala jnana	Omniscience at about 42, under a sal tree near the river Rijupalika
Nirvana	Pawapuri (Bihar), traditionally 527 BCE, at 72
Sects later	Digambara ("sky-clad", monks without clothes) and Shvetambara ("white-clad")

Basic principles common to both:

- Suffering exists and can be ended.
- Liberation comes by one's own effort, not by a creator god or rituals.
- Karma and rebirth.
- Non-violence (ahimsa) to all living beings.
- Ethical conduct as the foundation.
- Renunciation and self-discipline.
- Equality of all humans regardless of caste.
- Teaching in people's languages (Pali, Prakrit) instead of Sanskrit.

Scope:

- **Personal:** mental peace, self-control, character.
- **Social:** harmony, compassion, tolerance, justice.
- **Professional:** honest livelihood, integrity.
- **Environmental:** respect for all life, limited consumption.
- **Global:** peace and dialogue between views.

Examples and comparisons

Example 1 (testing teachings). In the Kalama Sutta the Buddha tells the Kalama people not to accept a teaching just because of tradition, scripture or a teacher's reputation, but to accept it when they know for themselves that it leads to welfare and happiness. An engineer applies the same attitude: test a claim before trusting it.

Example 2 (the four sights today). Siddhartha's sights of old age, sickness and death are the experiences every student will face in family life. The value lesson is that worldly success alone cannot protect us from suffering, so inner strength must also be developed.

Key points to remember

- Both are shramana, nastika darshans from 6th–5th century BCE Magadha.
- Buddha: Lumbini, Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, Kushinagar. Mahavira: Kundagrama, Pawapuri; 24th tirthankara.
- Common principles: suffering and its end, self-effort, karma and rebirth, ahimsa, ethics, equality.
- Need: rational ethics, mental well-being, tolerance, sustainability, heritage.

⭐ Important questions

1. Explain the need for studying human values in Bauddha and Jain darshan in today's life.
2. Describe the historical background and origin of Buddhism and Jainism.
3. Give a brief account of the lives of Gautama Buddha and Mahavira and their main teachings.
4. What are the basic principles common to Buddhism and Jainism? Explain their scope.
5. Distinguish between astika and nastika schools. Why are Buddhism and Jainism called shramana traditions?

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UNIT 2 Core Teachings of Buddhism

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Impermanence (anicca / anitya):** everything that arises is subject to change and passing away; nothing stays the same.
- **Suffering (dukkha / duhkha):** the unsatisfactoriness of conditioned existence: pain, change and the stress of clinging.
- **Non-self (anatta / anatman):** there is no permanent, unchanging self or soul; a person is a changing process of five aggregates.
- **Five aggregates (khandha / skandha):** form (rupa), feeling (vedana), perception (sanna), mental formations (sankhara) and consciousness (vinnana).
- **Craving (tanha / trishna):** thirst or desire that causes suffering: for sense pleasures, for existence and for non-existence.
- **Middle Way (majjhima patipada):** the path between the extremes of sense indulgence and self-torture.
- **Dependent origination (paticcasamuppada / pratityasamutpada):** everything arises dependent on conditions: "when this exists, that comes to be; when this ceases, that ceases."
- **Dhamma (dharma):** the Buddha's teaching, and the truth or natural law it describes.
- **Sangha:** the community of monks and nuns, and more broadly of all followers.
- **Five precepts (panchasila):** abstain from killing, stealing, sexual misconduct, false speech and intoxicants.

💡 Core concepts

Three marks of existence (tilakkhana): anicca (impermanence), dukkha (suffering) and anatta (non-self). Because things change (anicca), clinging to them brings suffering (dukkha), and since there is no fixed self to protect (anatta), letting go is possible.

Four Noble Truths (cattari ariyasaccani)

Truth	Pali	Meaning
1. Suffering	Dukkha	Life involves suffering: birth, ageing, sickness, death, separation from what we love, meeting what we dislike, not getting what we want
2. Cause of suffering	Samudaya	Suffering arises from craving (tanha) rooted in ignorance
3. Cessation of suffering	Nirodha	Suffering ends when craving ends; this state is nibbana
4. Path to cessation	Magga	The Noble Eightfold Path leads to the end of suffering

The Four Truths follow a doctor's method: the disease is named (dukkha), its cause is found (samudaya), a cure is declared possible (nirodha), and the treatment is prescribed (magga).

Noble Eightfold Path (ariya atthangika magga)

Group	Path factor	Meaning
Wisdom (panna)	1. Right view (samma ditthi)	Understanding the Four Noble Truths and karma
	2. Right intention (samma sankappa)	Intentions of renunciation, goodwill and harmlessness
Ethical conduct (sila)	3. Right speech (samma vaca)	No lying, divisive, harsh or idle speech
	4. Right action (samma kammanta)	No killing, stealing or sexual misconduct
	5. Right livelihood (samma ajiva)	Earning without harming others (not trading in weapons, living beings, meat, intoxicants, poison)
Concentration (samadhi)	6. Right effort (samma vayama)	Preventing and removing unwholesome states, developing and keeping wholesome ones
	7. Right mindfulness (samma sati)	Awareness of body, feelings, mind and mental objects
	8. Right concentration (samma samadhi)	One-pointed, calm mind (the jhanas)

The eight factors are developed together, not one after another. Sila supports samadhi, which supports panna.

Dependent origination (twelve links, nidanas):

1. Ignorance (avijja) conditions
2. mental formations (sankhara), which condition
3. consciousness (vinnana) →
4. name and form (namarupa) →
5. six sense bases (salayatana) →
6. contact (phassa) →
7. feeling (vedana) →
8. craving (tanha) →
9. clinging (upadana) →
10. becoming (bhava) →
11. birth (jati) →
12. ageing and death (jaramarana).

The chain explains how suffering continues without a permanent self. It can be broken, especially at the link between feeling and craving, through mindfulness: one feels without reacting with craving.

Key Buddhist terms:

- **Four brahmaviharas (sublime states):** metta (loving-kindness), karuna (compassion), mudita (sympathetic joy) and upekkha (equanimity).
- **Kusala and akusala:** wholesome and unwholesome actions.
- **Kamma (karma):** intention is action; "cetana is kamma".
- **Bodhisattva:** in Mahayana, one who delays final nirvana to help all beings.
- **Schools:** Theravada (Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand), Mahayana (China, Japan, Korea), Vajrayana (Tibet, Ladakh, Bhutan).
- **Texts:** Tipitaka (Vinaya, Sutta, Abhidhamma), Dhammapada.

Examples and comparisons

Example 3 (impermanence at work). A student is upset that a close friend got placed and moved to another city. Seeing anicca (all situations change) helps the student accept the change, keep the friendship in a new form and avoid prolonged sorrow.

Example 4 (breaking the chain). You see an advertisement for an expensive phone (contact) and feel pleasure (feeling). Usually craving follows, then clinging (taking a loan to buy it), then anxiety. A mindful person notices the pleasant feeling without letting it turn into craving, so the chain stops.

Example 5 (right livelihood for engineers). Writing honest test reports, refusing to design products meant to cheat customers, and not hiding safety defects all apply samma ajiva to a modern job.

Key points to remember

- Three marks: anicca, dukkha, anatta. Five aggregates.
- Four Noble Truths: dukkha, samudaya, nirodha, magga (doctor analogy).
- Eightfold Path in three groups: panna (1–2), sila (3–5), samadhi (6–8).
- Twelve links of dependent origination; break at feeling → craving.
- Brahmaviharas: metta, karuna, mudita, upekkha. Five precepts. Three jewels.

⭐ Important questions

1. Explain the Four Noble Truths of Buddhism. How are they relevant to human life today?
2. Explain the Noble Eightfold Path and its division into sila, samadhi and panna.
3. What is dependent origination (pratityasamutpada)? Explain the twelve links.
4. Explain the three marks of existence: impermanence, suffering and non-self.
5. Write notes on: Middle Way, five aggregates, four brahmaviharas, five precepts.

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UNIT 3 Purpose of Life, Roots of Suffering and Meditation in Buddhism

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Nibbana (nirvana):** literally "blowing out"; the complete ending of greed, hatred and delusion, and so of suffering and rebirth; the highest goal in Buddhism.
- **Arahant (arhat):** one who has attained nirvana in this life.
- **Three roots of unwholesome action (akusala mula):** greed (lobha), hatred or aversion (dosa) and delusion or ignorance (moha).
- **Three wholesome roots:** non-greed (alobha, generosity), non-hatred (adosa, loving-kindness) and non-delusion (amoha, wisdom).
- **Meditation (bhavana):** literally "cultivation"; mental training to develop calm, clarity and insight.
- **Shamatha (samatha):** calm-abiding meditation that steadies and concentrates the mind on one object, such as the breath.
- **Vipassana (vipashyana):** insight meditation that observes sensations and mental events to see their impermanence, suffering and non-self nature directly.
- **Anapana sati:** mindfulness of breathing in and out; used to develop concentration.
- **Equanimity (upekkha / upeksha):** a balanced mind that does not react with craving to pleasant experiences or with aversion to unpleasant ones.
- **Mindfulness (sati):** clear, present-moment awareness of what is happening in the body and mind.

💡 Core concepts

Purpose of life in Buddhism: freedom from suffering (dukkha nirodha) for oneself and others, by purifying the mind through ethics, meditation and wisdom. The final goal is nirvana. Along the way, a person becomes peaceful, kind and wise, which benefits society.

Nirvana:

- Not a place or a heaven; it is the state in which the "fires" of greed, hatred and delusion are extinguished.
- **Two aspects:** nirvana with remainder (the arahant still lives in a body) and parinirvana (at death, no further rebirth).
- **Described as** peace (santi), freedom, the deathless and the highest happiness.

Roots of suffering:

- **The three roots:** greed (lobha), hatred (dosa) and delusion (moha), sometimes pictured as a cock (greed), a snake (hatred) and a pig (delusion) at the hub of the wheel of life.
- All unwholesome actions arise from them, and they lead to suffering for oneself and others.
- **Antidotes:** generosity (dana) for greed, loving-kindness (metta) for hatred, and wisdom (panna) for delusion.

- **Craving and clinging:** we suffer not just because of events but because of how we react to them (wanting more, pushing away). The parable of the **second arrow** shows this: being hit by an arrow is pain (unavoidable), and reacting with worry and anger is a second arrow (avoidable).

Shamatha and vipassana

	Shamatha (calm)	Vipassana (insight)
Aim	Concentration, calm, a stable mind	Wisdom, seeing reality as it is
Method	Focus on one object (breath, kasina, metta phrases)	Observe changing sensations, thoughts and feelings without reacting
Result	Jhanas (absorptions), peace, temporary suppression of hindrances	Direct understanding of anicca, dukkha, anatta; uprooting of defilements
Relationship	Prepares the mind	Uses the calm mind to gain liberating insight

Vipassana as taught in the S. N. Goenka tradition (Vipassana Research Institute, Igatpuri, Maharashtra):

- Ten-day residential courses with noble silence.
- First three and a half days of anapana (breath awareness) to sharpen concentration.
- Then vipassana: systematically observing body sensations with equanimity, understanding their impermanence.
- Last day: metta (loving-kindness) meditation.
- Five precepts are kept throughout.
- The technique is non-sectarian and is used in schools and prisons (for example Tihar Jail, Delhi, since 1993).

Five hindrances (nivarana) to meditation: sensual desire, ill will, sloth and torpor, restlessness and worry, and doubt.

Equanimity (upekkha):

- Not indifference but a balanced, wise mind.
- Lets a person act with clarity under stress; it is one of the four brahmaviharas and one of the seven factors of enlightenment.
- Developed by repeatedly observing sensations without reacting.

Benefits supported by modern studies: mindfulness-based programmes (such as Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction, MBSR, by Jon Kabat-Zinn, 1979) reduce stress, anxiety and relapse of depression, and improve attention.

Examples and comparisons

Example 6 (second arrow before exams). A student scores low in a mid-semester test (first arrow). Thinking "I will fail, my life is ruined" all week is the second arrow. Noticing the disappointment calmly and planning revision avoids the extra suffering.

Example 7 (ten minutes of anapana). Sitting upright, eyes closed, the student watches natural breath at the nostrils. When the mind wanders, they notice and gently return. After a few weeks of daily practice, concentration during study improves.

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Example 8 (equanimity at work). A project lead receives harsh criticism from a client. With equanimity, the lead listens, separates useful points from tone, and replies calmly, instead of reacting with anger (dosa) that spoils the relationship.

Key points to remember

- Purpose: freedom from suffering; nirvana = extinction of greed, hatred, delusion.
- Three roots and their antidotes (dana, metta, panna). Second arrow parable.
- Shamatha (calm, concentration) vs vipassana (insight, wisdom); anapana first, then vipassana.
- Five hindrances. Equanimity is balance, not indifference.
- Goenka tradition: 10-day course, VRI Igatpuri; MBSR in modern psychology.

⭐ Important questions

1. What is the purpose of life according to Buddhism? Explain nirvana.
2. Explain the three roots of suffering and their antidotes with examples.
3. Differentiate shamatha and vipassana meditation. Describe the method of vipassana.
4. What is equanimity (upekkha)? How does it help in personal and professional life?
5. Discuss the relevance of Buddhist meditation for students today.

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UNIT 4 Core Teachings of Jainism

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Jiva:** the soul or living, conscious substance; it is eternal and has infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy, which karma obscures.
- **Ajiva:** non-living substances that have no consciousness (matter, the media of motion and rest, space and time).
- **Tattva:** a fundamental truth or category of reality relevant to liberation.
- **Dravya:** an eternal substance that makes up the universe; Jainism lists six.
- **Ratnatraya (three jewels of Jainism):** right faith (samyak darshana), right knowledge (samyak jnana) and right conduct (samyak charitra), which together form the path to liberation.
- **Anekantavada:** the doctrine of many-sidedness: reality has infinite aspects, and no single viewpoint captures the whole truth.
- **Syadvada:** the doctrine of conditional predication: every statement should be qualified with "syat" (in some respect, from some viewpoint).
- **Nayavada:** the doctrine of partial standpoints (nayas) from which a thing can be described.
- **Karma (in Jainism):** fine particles of matter (karmic pudgala) that are attracted to and bind the soul because of passions and activity, hiding its true nature.
- **Kashaya (passions):** anger (krodha), pride (mana), deceit (maya) and greed (lobha), which cause karma to stick to the soul.

💡 Core concepts

Nine tattvas (nava tattva):

#	Tattva	Meaning
1	Jiva	The soul, conscious being
2	Ajiva	Non-living substance
3	Punya	Merit, auspicious karma from good actions
4	Papa	Demerit, inauspicious karma from bad actions
5	Asrava	Inflow of karmic matter into the soul
6	Bandha	Bondage of karma with the soul
7	Samvara	Stopping the inflow of new karma (by vows, vigilance, self-control)
8	Nirjara	Shedding of accumulated karma (by austerity, tapas)
9	Moksha	Liberation: complete freedom of the soul from all karma

Many texts (such as the Tattvartha Sutra) count seven tattvas, putting punya and papa within asrava and bandha. A classic illustration is a **boat**: the soul is the boat, the water is karma, the holes are asrava, the

water inside is bandha, plugging the holes is samvara, bailing out water is nirjara, and reaching the shore dry is moksha.

Six dravyas (substances):

1. **Jiva:** souls (infinite in number).
2. **Pudgala:** matter (atoms and their combinations; has touch, taste, smell, colour).
3. **Dharma:** the medium of motion (like water helping a fish move). Not the same as "dharma" meaning religion.
4. **Adharma:** the medium of rest (like the shade of a tree for a tired traveller).
5. **Akasha:** space, which gives room to all substances.
6. **Kala:** time, which allows change.

The first five (all except kala) are called **astikaya** (extended substances). The universe (loka) is the space where all six exist, and is beginningless and uncreated (no creator god).

Ratnatraya (three jewels):

- **Right faith (samyak darshana):** conviction in the true nature of reality (the tattvas), free from superstition.
- **Right knowledge (samyak jnana):** correct and complete understanding without doubt or error. Five kinds of knowledge: mati (sensory), shruta (scriptural or verbal), avadhi (clairvoyance), manahparyaya (telepathy), kevala (omniscience).
- **Right conduct (samyak charitra):** living by the vows (ahimsa and the others) and self-discipline.
- **Key text:** Tattvartha Sutra of Umaswati (Umasvami): "samyag-darshana-jnana-charitrani moksha-margah", meaning right faith, right knowledge and right conduct together are the path to liberation. All three are needed, like the three legs of a stool (or medicine, which helps only when you trust it, know it and take it).

Anekantavada (many-sidedness):

- Reality is complex and has many aspects; ordinary people see only part of it.
- **Parable of the blind men and the elephant:** each touches one part (trunk, leg, ear, tail) and insists it is a snake, pillar, fan or rope. Each is partly right, and the whole truth includes all views.
- **Value:** intellectual humility, tolerance, non-violence in thought, and dialogue.

Syadvada and saptabhangi (seven-fold predication): "syat" means "in some respect". About a pot:

1. Syad asti: in some respect it is (exists as a clay pot, here, now).
2. Syad nasti: in some respect it is not (it is not a cloth, not elsewhere).
3. Syad asti nasti: in some respect it is and is not.
4. Syad avaktavya: in some respect it is indescribable (both at once cannot be said together).
5. Syad asti avaktavya: in some respect it is, and is indescribable.
6. Syad nasti avaktavya: in some respect it is not, and is indescribable.
7. Syad asti nasti avaktavya: in some respect it is, is not, and is indescribable.

Jain theory of karma:

- Karma is subtle matter; activity of body, speech and mind (yoga) attracts it (asrava), and passions (kashaya) make it stick (bandha).

- **Bondage has four aspects:** nature (prakriti), duration (sthiti), intensity (anubhaga), quantity (pradesha).
- **Eight types of karma:**
- Four **ghatiya** (destructive, obscure the soul's qualities): knowledge-obscuring (jnanavaraniya), perception-obscuring (darshanavaraniya), deluding (mohaniya, the most powerful) and obstructing (antaraya).
- Four **aghatiya** (non-destructive, relate to the body and circumstances): feeling (vedaniya), lifespan (ayu), body-making (nama) and status (gotra).
- **Leshya:** the "colour" of the soul according to its moral state, from black (worst) to white (purest).
- There is no god who rewards or punishes; the soul is its own master.

Examples and comparisons

Example 9 (anekanta in a team). A design team argues: the mechanical engineer wants a heavier frame for strength, the electrical engineer wants space for batteries, and the finance lead wants lower cost. Applying anekantavada, each view is accepted as partly true, and the final design balances all three.

Example 10 (asrava and samvara in habits). Scrolling social media for hours brings in "inflow" (asrava) of distraction and comparison. Setting app limits and fixed study hours is samvara (stopping inflow). Daily exercise and reflection that clear accumulated stress are like nirjara.

Example 11 (syadvada in a debate). Instead of saying "online classes are bad", a student says "in some respects (lack of interaction) online classes are worse, in others (flexibility, recorded lectures) they are better". This keeps the discussion respectful and closer to the truth.

Key points to remember

- Nine tattvas: jiva, ajiva, punya, papa, asrava, bandha, samvara, nirjara, moksha (boat analogy).
- Six dravyas: jiva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasha, kala; five astikayas.
- Ratnatraya: samyak darshana, jnana, charitra (Tattvartha Sutra); five kinds of knowledge.
- Anekantavada (blind men and elephant), syadvada (seven predications), nayavada.
- Karma as matter; four passions; eight karmas (4 ghatiya, 4 aghatiya).

⭐ Important questions

1. Explain the nine tattvas of Jainism with a suitable illustration.
2. What are the six dravyas? Explain the Jain view of the universe.
3. Explain ratnatraya (right faith, right knowledge, right conduct) as the path to liberation.
4. Explain anekantavada and syadvada with examples. What is their value in modern society?
5. Describe the Jain theory of karma and the types of karma.

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UNIT 5 Liberation, Vows, Ten-fold Dharma and Modern Relevance

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Moksha (in Jainism):** complete liberation of the soul from all karmic matter; the soul regains infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy and rises to the top of the universe (siddhashila).
- **Kevala jnana:** omniscience (perfect, complete knowledge) attained when the four destructive karmas are destroyed.
- **Siddha:** a liberated soul with no body, dwelling at the top of the universe.
- **Mahavrata (great vows):** the five vows taken in full by Jain monks and nuns: ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, aparigraha.
- **Anuvrata (small vows):** the same five vows taken in a limited form by lay people (householders).
- **Ahimsa:** non-violence in thought, word and deed toward all living beings, including the smallest.
- **Aparigraha:** non-possessiveness: limiting possessions and detaching from them.
- **Das Lakshana Dharma (ten-fold dharma):** the ten virtues of the soul, such as supreme forgiveness and humility, celebrated during the Das Lakshan Parva (Paryushana).
- **Sallekhana (santhara):** a vow of gradually reducing food at the end of life, undertaken with equanimity when death is near.
- **Micchami dukkadam:** a Prakrit phrase meaning "may all my wrongdoing be fruitless", said while asking forgiveness on Kshamavani (forgiveness day) at the end of Paryushana.

💡 Core concepts

Moksha and the path:

- Moksha is reached by stopping new karma (samvara) and removing old karma (nirjara) through the three jewels, vows and austerity (tapas).
- **Fourteen stages of spiritual development (gunasthana):** the soul rises from delusion (mithyatva) to the final stage of liberation.
- **Twelve kinds of austerity:**
- Six external: fasting, reduced eating, limiting kinds of food, giving up tasty food, solitude, bodily endurance.
- Six internal: repentance (prayashchitta), humility (vinaya), service (vaiyavritya), study (svadhyaya), renouncing the body (kayotsarga), meditation (dhyana).

Five vows: great vows (monks) vs small vows (lay people)

Vow	Mahavrata (complete)	Anuvrata (partial, for householders)
Ahimsa (non-violence)	No harm to any living being, even insects; careful walking and eating	Avoid intentional harm; vegetarian diet; avoid violent trades
Satya (truth)	Never lie, even in jest; speak only what is true and beneficial	Avoid lies that harm others (false witness, cheating)

Vow	Mahavrata (complete)	Anuvrata (partial, for householders)
Asteya (non-stealing)	Take nothing not given	No theft, no cheating in weights and measures, no tax evasion
Brahmacharya (chastity)	Complete celibacy	Faithfulness to one's spouse
Aparigraha (non-possession)	Own nothing beyond a few essentials (Digambara monks not even clothes)	Set a limit on wealth and possessions, give the surplus

Lay people also take three **gunavratas** (limiting travel, limiting consumables, avoiding purposeless harm) and four **shikshavratas** (meditation periods, further limits, fasting days, giving to monks and the needy). Together with the five anuvratas these make the **twelve vows of a householder**. In 1949 Acharya Tulsi started the **Anuvrat movement** to spread these small vows as a non-sectarian code of good conduct.

Ten-fold dharma (Das Lakshana Dharma), each with "uttama" (supreme):

1. **Kshama:** forgiveness, freedom from anger.
2. **Mardava:** humility, freedom from pride.
3. **Arjava:** straightforwardness, freedom from deceit.
4. **Shaucha:** purity, freedom from greed (contentment).
5. **Satya:** truthfulness.
6. **Samyama:** self-restraint of senses and mind, and care for all life.
7. **Tapa:** austerity and self-discipline.
8. **Tyaga:** renunciation and charity.
9. **Akinchanya:** non-attachment, the feeling that "nothing is mine".
10. **Brahmacharya:** chastity, dwelling in the self.

The first four directly counter the four passions: anger, pride, deceit and greed.

Commonality and differences: Buddhism and Jainism

Aspect	Buddhism	Jainism
Common ground	Shramana origin, reject Vedic authority and animal sacrifice, no creator god, karma and rebirth, ahimsa, ethics, monastic order, liberation by own effort, use of people's language	Same
Founder	Gautama Buddha (founder)	Mahavira (24th tirthankara, reformer of an older tradition)
Soul	Anatta: no permanent self	Jiva: eternal individual souls
Karma	Mental intention (cetana)	Subtle matter sticking to the soul
Path	Middle Way, avoiding extreme austerity	Strict austerity, five great vows
Ahimsa	Central, but more moderate in practice	Extremely strict (careful walking, filtered water, no root vegetables for many)
Knowledge	Four Noble Truths, dependent origination	Anekantavada, syadvada
Goal	Nirvana	Moksha (siddha state)

Aspect	Buddhism	Jainism
Spread	Spread widely across Asia	Remained mainly in India

Modern relevance:

- **Environment:** ahimsa and aparigraha support conservation, low consumption and vegetarian diets (lower carbon footprint).
- **Mental health:** mindfulness and vipassana for stress, anxiety and focus.
- **Conflict resolution:** anekantavada and right speech for dialogue in a polarized world.
- **Business ethics:** right livelihood, truth and non-stealing for corporate governance.
- **Consumerism:** contentment and limits on wants counter debt and waste.
- **Social justice:** rejection of caste discrimination (Dr B. R. Ambedkar embraced Buddhism in 1956).
- **Non-violent movements:** Gandhi was deeply influenced by Jain ideas of ahimsa and truth, and by his Jain friend Shrimad Rajchandra.
- **Animal welfare and compassion.**

Examples and comparisons

Example 12 (aparigraha budget). A new engineer earning ₹60,000 a month sets a personal limit: rent and needs ₹30,000, savings ₹20,000, wants ₹5,000, giving ₹5,000. Fixing a limit in advance is a modern anuvrata of aparigraha and protects against debt.

Example 13 (kshama on campus). A roommate damages your laptop charger and apologizes. Holding a grudge (anger) harms your peace for weeks. Practising uttama kshama, you forgive, agree on replacement, and keep the friendship.

Example 14 (ahimsa in engineering). Designing a factory with proper effluent treatment, safe working conditions and minimal waste applies ahimsa beyond diet: it avoids harm to workers, communities and other living beings.

Key points to remember

- Moksha: freedom from all karma, kevala jnana, siddha; samvara + nirjara; 12 austerities; 14 gunasthanas.
- Five vows: mahavrata (full) vs anuvrata (partial); 12 householder vows; Anuvrat movement (Acharya Tulsi, 1949).
- Ten-fold dharma: kshama, mardava, arjava, shaucha, satya, samyama, tapa, tyaga, akinchanya, brahmacharya.
- Comparison table: common ground and the differences (anatta vs jiva, Middle Way vs austerity).
- Relevance: environment, mental health, conflict, business ethics, consumerism, social justice, Gandhi.

⭐ Important questions

1. Explain the concept of moksha in Jainism and the path to attain it.
2. Explain the five mahavratas and anuvratas. How can a modern professional follow them?
3. Explain the ten-fold dharma (Das Lakshana Dharma) and its significance.

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4. Compare Buddhism and Jainism, bringing out their commonalities and differences.
5. Discuss the relevance of Bauddha and Jain values in modern life (environment, mental health, conflict, business).

Last-hour checklist

☐ Need for these darshans; shramana and nastika; lives of the Buddha (Lumbini, Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, Kushinagar) and Mahavira (Kundagrama, Pawapuri); common principles; scope.

☐ Three marks; five aggregates; Four Noble Truths (doctor analogy); Eightfold Path in three groups; twelve links of dependent origination; brahmaviharas; five precepts; three jewels.

☐ Purpose and nirvana; three roots and antidotes; second arrow; shamatha vs vipassana table; anapana; five hindrances; equanimity; Goenka 10-day course.

☐ Nine tattvas (boat analogy); six dravyas; ratnatraya and Tattvartha Sutra; five kinds of knowledge; anekantavada (elephant); saptabhangi; eight karmas; four passions.

☐ Moksha and siddha; mahavrata vs anuvrata table; 12 householder vows; ten-fold dharma; Buddhism vs Jainism table; modern relevance with examples.

Books prescribed by AKTU

These are the books named in the official AKTU syllabus. Buy or borrow them through a bookshop or your college library. The WorldCat links show which libraries hold a copy.

#	Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Where to get it legally
1	An Introduction to Indian Philosophy	Satischandra Chatterjee, Dhirendramohan Datta	University of Calcutta (1960)	WorldCat
2	The Dhammapada (reference)	Translation	Vipassana Research Institute (2001)	WorldCat
3	The Discourse Summaries (reference)	S. N. Goenka	Vipassana Research Institute (1987)	WorldCat
4	Sarva-darshana-samgraha (reference)	Madhavacharya	Chaukhambha (1984)	WorldCat
5	Samansuttam, 7th edition (reference)	Compiled by Jinendra Varni	Sarva Seva Sangh Prakashan (2010)	WorldCat
6	Musings from the Heart (reference)	Gyalwang Drukpa	(2018)	WorldCat

Syllabus source: AKTU Open Elective-III and IV syllabus for B.Tech 8th semester, 2025-26 (copy hosted by an affiliated college, PDF)